

First Fictions Festival at Sussex

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Last weekend, the 20th to 22nd of January 2012, saw the inaugural event of the First Fictions Festival at the University of Sussex. Having been a key behind-the-scenes organizer I just wanted to post a thank you to all involved for a succesful weekend. We had headline events from Ian Rankin (in which it emerged that he, like me, had harboured aspirataions of pursuing a Ph.D on Thomas Pynchon, only to be told he'd only get funding for Muriel Spark and so defected!), the judging panel for the First Graphic Novel Competition (won by [Gareth Brooks](#)), Adam Roberts, Elleke Boehmer and a whole host of other academic papers and fictions writers.

Sadly, my attendance on the third day was curtailed by illness, but with any luck, this is just the start of a bigger series of events, in partnership with Myriad Editions.